

Andrey Pautov

Cyber Threat Intelligence Researcher | Adversary & Detection Research | AI-Assisted Security

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Professional Summary

Cybersecurity researcher focused on cyber threat intelligence, adversary TTP analysis, malware triage, detection engineering, and AI-assisted security research. Current Threat Intelligence Research Engineer at XPLG, with prior red-team experience in a law-enforcement cyber defence unit and a strong independent research portfolio.

Author of 140+ technical articles and research guides covering APT activity, threat hunting, malware analysis, telecom and cloud security, AI-assisted security workflows, MCP-based security automation, and detection methodology. Experienced in converting open-source and technical evidence into SOC-actionable intelligence products.

Core Strengths

- Cyber threat intelligence research, adversary profiling, and campaign analysis
- ATT&CK-based TTP mapping, evidence labeling, confidence assessment, and analytic writing
- Malware triage, static analysis, IOC enrichment, and reverse-engineering fundamentals
- Detection engineering, threat hunting, SIEM/TIP workflows, and log-analysis methodology
- Offensive-security-informed CTI, red-team tradecraft analysis, and vulnerability context
- AI-assisted analyst workflows, LLM tooling, MCP integrations, and automation development

Professional Experience

XPLG - Threat Intelligence Research Engineer

2025 - Current

- Research adversary behavior, active campaigns, malware activity, and operational tradecraft for security operations teams.
- Analyze IOCs, public reporting, malware indicators, infrastructure patterns, and threat-actor TTPs; translate findings into structured intelligence and defensive recommendations.
- Build and document detection-oriented workflows for log analysis, SIEM/TIP enrichment, threat hunting, and incident investigation support.
- Apply AI-assisted analysis and automation to support CTI collection, enrichment, summarization, and repeatable analyst workflows.

Israel Police - Cyber Defence Unit, Red Team

2023 - 2025

- Performed red-team and offensive security work in a law-enforcement cyber defence environment.
- Conducted reconnaissance, vulnerability assessment, exploitation validation, and attack-path analysis across controlled environments.
- Supported practical security testing across network, web, endpoint, and Active Directory-focused attack surfaces.

Independent Security Researcher / Penetration-Testing Tool Developer

2022 - Current

- Develop and document security tools, automation scripts, vulnerable labs, and repeatable research environments for offensive security, CTI, and detection engineering.
- Publish technical research on APT activity, threat hunting, malware analysis, cloud and Kubernetes security, telecom threat mapping, and AI-assisted security operations.
- Produce analyst-style reports with executive summaries, evidence labels, ATT&CK mappings, IOC tables, defensive priorities, and SOC-ready recommendations.

Selected Research & Publications

- APT and CTI research: Sandworm/APT44, MuddyWater/Seedworm, Handala Hack Group, telecom-sector threats, infrastructure pivoting, attribution methodology, and threat-actor tradecraft.
- Detection engineering and threat hunting: anomaly-based detection analysis, single-event and correlation-based detection rules, endpoint threat hunting, protocol-level hunting, and Pyramid of Pain methodology.
- AI-assisted security research: AI-driven penetration testing, MCP-based security-tool orchestration, autonomous lab testing, AI-assisted reconnaissance, and AI-supported forensic workflows.
- Cloud, infrastructure, and malware research: AWS, GCP, Kubernetes, Active Directory, ADCS ESC8, CI/CD threat modeling, Android malware analysis, file fingerprinting, strings analysis, and IOC enrichment.
- Telecom security research includes cyberattacks on 5G core networks mapped to MITRE ATT&CK and FiGHT frameworks.

Technical Skills

- Research & CTI: Threat intelligence, adversary TTP analysis, ATT&CK mapping, IOC enrichment, malware triage, attribution methodology, evidence labeling, technical writing
- Detection & Operations: Detection engineering, threat hunting, SIEM/TIP workflows, log analysis, incident analysis, SOC-ready reporting, defensive playbooks, data analysis
- Offensive Security: Penetration testing, red teaming, vulnerability assessment, web application testing, Active Directory testing, cloud/Kubernetes testing, reconnaissance, exploitation validation

- Engineering & Platforms: Python, Bash, PowerShell, C++, Assembly basics, Linux, AWS/GCP, MCP/LLM workflows

Tools & Technologies

Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit, Wireshark, Shodan, Censys, SpiderFoot, theHarvester, Amass, SQLMap, Nikto, OWASP ZAP, Hashcat, John the Ripper, IOC enrichment workflows, Linux security tooling, Active Directory and ADACS attack tooling, Kubernetes and cloud security tooling, Cursor, Gemini CLI, HexStrike-AI, MCP-based integrations.

Education, Earlier Career & Languages

- 120+ professional courses and certificates across cybersecurity, data, DevOps, cloud, and security operations.
- Continuous independent research and publication program focused on CTI, detection engineering, offensive security, malware analysis, and AI-assisted security.
- Earlier career: Special Forces Paramedic / Fighter (2016 - 2023); ICU Paramedic (2011 - 2016).
- Languages: Russian native; Hebrew bilingual; English professional working proficiency.